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Institutional Identity and History

(From Official FAST National University Website — nu.edu.pk and Wikipedia — National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences)

The National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences, commonly known as FAST National University or FAST-NUCES, is a private federally chartered research university with multiple campuses across Pakistan. The university is formally recognized by the Higher Education Commission of Pakistan and is consistently ranked among the leading institutions of higher education in the country. It holds the top position in computer sciences and information technology as ranked by the Higher Education Commission of Pakistan in 2020.

History: The university traces its roots to the Foundation for Advancement of Science and Technology, known as FAST, which established four first-rate computer science institutes in Karachi, Lahore, Islamabad, and Peshawar. These institutes individually and collectively built strong leadership positions through enlightened management and a highly qualified faculty. The National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences was formally established and inaugurated by President Pervez Musharraf as a Federally Chartered University in July 2000, under Ordinance Number Twenty-Three of 2000, dated July 1, 2000. It holds the distinction of being the first multi-campus private sector university established under a Federal Charter in Pakistan.

Recognition and Rankings: The university is fully recognized and accredited by the Higher Education Commission of Pakistan. It is a member of the Association of Commonwealth Universities of the United Kingdom. The university has active research wings at its Islamabad, Lahore, Peshawar, and Karachi campuses, which are nationally and internationally recognized and conduct research with direct impact on the social, economic, and technological needs of Pakistan.

Campus Infrastructure

(From Official FAST Karachi Campus Website — khi.nu.edu.pk and Wikipedia — National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences)

The university currently operates six campuses located in Karachi, Lahore, Islamabad, Peshawar, Multan, and Chiniot-Faisalabad. These campuses collectively provide world-class educational environments and recreational facilities to over eleven thousand students, of whom approximately one quarter are female, supported by over five hundred skilled faculty members.

Karachi Main Campus: The primary campus is located at Street 4, Sector 17-D on the National Highway in Shah Latif Town, Karachi. This campus operates from 8 am to 4 pm, five days a week. Parking is available for students arriving by car or motorcycle, situated just outside the main gate.

Karachi City Campus: A secondary campus is located at 22-G, Block 6, PECHS, Shahrah-e-Faisal, Karachi. This campus remains open until 9 pm and operates six days a week, catering to students who attend evening programs and professionals seeking continuing education.

University Headquarters: The central administrative headquarters of the university is located at FAST House, Rohtas Road, G-9/4, Islamabad.

Academic Programs — Karachi Campus

(From Official FAST Karachi Campus Website — khi.nu.edu.pk and Official FAST National University Degree Programs Page — nu.edu.pk/Degree-Programs)

The Karachi campus is organized into seven academic departments: the Department of Computer Science, the Department of Cyber Security, the Department of Artificial Intelligence, the Department of Software Engineering, the Department of Electrical

Engineering, the Department of Management Sciences, and the Department of Sciences and Humanities.

Bachelor of Science Undergraduate Programs

The following Bachelor of Science programs are offered at the Karachi campus: Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Bachelor of Science in Artificial Intelligence, Bachelor of Science in Data Science, Bachelor of Science in Cyber Security, Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering, Bachelor of Science in Electrical Engineering, Bachelor of Science in Business Analytics, and Bachelor of Science in Financial Technologies.

All undergraduate programs are four-year programs divided into eight semesters.

Master of Science Graduate Programs

The following Master of Science programs are offered at the Karachi campus: Master of Science in Computer Science, Master of Science in Software Engineering, Master of Science in Artificial Intelligence, Master of Science in Data Science, Master of Science in Cyber Security, Master of Science in Software Project Management, Master of Science in Electrical Engineering, and Master of Science in Business Analytics.

Doctoral Programs — PhD

The following PhD programs are offered at the Karachi campus: Doctor of Philosophy in Computer Science, Doctor of Philosophy in Software Engineering, and Doctor of Philosophy in Electrical Engineering.

Admission Policy (2025-2026)

(From Official FAST National University Eligibility Criteria Page — nu.edu.pk/Admissions/EligibilityCriteria, updated August 6, 2025)

Merit Formula

FAST National University uses a clearly defined merit formula that differs by program category. There is no interview for undergraduate admissions at any campus.

For Bachelor of Science Engineering programs including Civil Engineering, Electrical Engineering, and Computer Engineering, the merit score is calculated as 33% weightage on the admission test score, 50% weightage on the Higher Secondary Certificate or equivalent result, and 17% weightage on the Secondary School Certificate or equivalent result. The minimum eligibility requirement is 60% marks in both the Secondary School Certificate and the Higher Secondary Certificate. The required subjects at Higher Secondary Certificate level are Pre-Engineering covering Chemistry, Mathematics, and Physics, or the Intermediate Certificate of Science covering Computer Science, Mathematics, and Physics.

For Bachelor of Science Computing programs including Computer Science, Artificial Intelligence, Cyber Security, Data Science, and Software Engineering, the merit score is calculated as 50% weightage on the admission test score, 40% weightage on the Higher Secondary Certificate or equivalent result, and 10% weightage on the Secondary School Certificate or equivalent result. The minimum eligibility requirement is 60% marks in the Secondary School Certificate and 50% marks in the Higher Secondary Certificate. Mathematics must have been studied at the Higher Secondary Certificate level. Pre-Medical students who have passed additional Mathematics, or who are awaiting results for additional Mathematics, are also eligible to apply for Computing programs.

For Bachelor of Business Administration and Business-related Bachelor of Science programs including Business Analytics, Accounting and Finance, and Financial Technology, the merit formula is identical to the Computing programs: 50% admission test, 40% Higher Secondary Certificate, and 10% Secondary School Certificate. The minimum requirement is 60% in Secondary School Certificate and 50% in Higher Secondary Certificate. There is no specific subject restriction at the Higher Secondary Certificate level for business programs.

For Master of Science programs in Computing and Engineering disciplines, the selection is based on 50% weightage on the admission test score and 50% weightage on the undergraduate academic record. Eligibility requires a Bachelor degree from a recognized university after 16 years of education with a minimum of 60% marks or a Cumulative Grade Point Average of at least 2.00 on a scale of 4.00.

For Master of Science in Mathematics and Applied Linguistics, the minimum eligibility threshold is reduced to 55% marks or a Cumulative Grade Point Average of at least 2.00 on a 4.00 scale.

For Master of Science in Software Project Management, in addition to academic qualifications, applicants must possess a minimum of two years of professional experience related to Software Development Lifecycle activities as a software engineer or equivalent role in a software development firm.

For PhD programs, eligibility requires an 18-year education pathway with a Master of Science, Master of Philosophy, or equivalent degree with a minimum of 60% marks or a Cumulative Grade Point Average of at least 3.00 on a 4.00 scale. PhD merit is determined as 60% weightage on the admission test score and 40% weightage on a panel interview assessing research potential. The minimum passing mark in the admission test is 60%. Students with a Cumulative Grade Point Average between 2.90 and 3.00, or between 58% and 60% in the annual system, may be provisionally admitted subject to successful completion of a Zero Semester, during which they must study nine additional credit hours of Level 7 courses and achieve a minimum Grade Point Average of 3.00. For the PhD in Management Sciences, selection criteria are based on performance in the Graduate Management Admission Test or an equivalent test, an interview and assessment by the Doctoral Admissions Committee, and submission of a Research Proposal.

Entry Test Details

(From Official FAST National University Admissions Page — nu.edu.pk/Admissions and pmdc.org.pk — NUCES Admission Guide 2025)

The FAST National University Admission Test, known as FNET, is a Computer-Based Test administered at all FAST campuses nationwide. For Fall 2025, the test was held starting July 20, 2025. The test evaluates problem-solving, quantitative reasoning, analytical, and English language skills. A minimum passing score, which varies by campus and program, is required for admission.

Applicants for undergraduate programs must select only one of three test options: the FAST National University Admission Test, the Scholastic Assessment Test, or the National Testing Service National Aptitude Test under the relevant category. Note that National Testing Service tests from specific universities are not acceptable. For postgraduate programs, applicants may choose between the FAST National University test, the Graduate Record Examination General, or the National Testing Service Graduate Assessment Test under the relevant General or Subject category.

Weightage of Higher Secondary Certificate marks is calculated based on whichever is applicable at the time of merit compilation: marks obtained in Higher Secondary Certificate Parts One and Two combined, marks obtained in Part One only if Part Two results are not yet available, or the percentage provided in the Inter Board Committee of Chairmen equivalence certificate for Advanced Level or Ordinary Level qualifications. Students who have taken the Higher Secondary Certificate or an equivalent examination and are still awaiting their result are also eligible to apply.

Any incorrect or false information submitted by the applicant, or any attempt to conceal information, will lead to disqualification from admission.

Fee Structure (2025-2026)

(From Official FAST National University Fee Structure Page —
nu.edu.pk/Admissions/FeeStructure, effective from Fall 2025 semester)

One-Time Charges at Admission

An Admission Fee of Rs. 30,000 is payable once at the time of admission. If a graduate of FAST National University is admitted to a higher degree program at the same university, the admission fee is not charged again. A refundable Security Deposit of Rs. 20,000 is also payable at the time of admission. The Applicant Admission Fee, which is the fee for submitting an application, is Rs. 3,000 and is non-refundable.

Tuition Fee — Effective Fall 2025

Tuition fee is payable in full before the start of each semester and is subject to annual revision. For the academic year 2025 to 2026, the tuition fee per credit hour is Rs. 11,000 and this rate applies equally to Bachelor of Science and Bachelor of Business Administration programs, Master of Business Administration and Master of Science programs, and PhD programs. A standard semester carries approximately 15 to 18 credit hours, making the approximate tuition fee per semester between Rs. 165,000 and Rs. 198,000 for all program levels.

Student Activities Fund

A Student Activities Fund contribution of Rs. 2,500 per semester is collected from every student effective from Fall 2024. This fund supports co-curricular and extra-curricular activities across all campuses.

Miscellaneous Fees

Additional fees that may apply include an Additional Transcript fee of Rs. 300, a Campus Transfer fee of Rs. 5,000, a Temporary Campus Transfer fee of Rs. 2,000, a Degree Correction fee of Rs. 2,000, a Semester Freeze Fee of Rs. 2,000 if applied within two weeks of the start of classes, a Late Registration or Freeze or Course Withdrawal fee of Rs. 5,000 if applied after the second week, a Retake Sessional Exam fee of Rs. 2,000 per course, a Retake Final Exam fee of Rs. 2,000 per course or lab, a Paper Rechecking fee of Rs. 500 per course or lab, and an Issuance of Certificate or Letter fee of Rs. 300. All miscellaneous fees are non-refundable.

Late Payment Fine

A late payment fine is charged on the entire outstanding fee, including current dues and arrears, at a rate of Re. 1.00 per day for every one thousand rupees of outstanding balance. Student registration is suspended two months after the due date for payment if the fee remains unpaid.

Payment Methods

Fee can be paid by printing the challan form and depositing at any Faysal Bank branch, or via the Kuickpay payment gateway using internet banking, mobile banking, or an ATM. Kuickpay is supported by Allied Bank, Askari Bank, Bank Al Habib, Bank Alfalah, Bank Islami, Bank of Punjab, Dubai Islamic Bank, Faysal Bank, First Women Bank, Habib Metro Bank, Habib Bank Limited, JS Bank, MCB Bank, MCB Islamic Bank, Meezan Bank, National Bank, and several others. Easypaisa and JazzCash can also be used for payment via Kuickpay, subject to applicable transaction limits.

Refund Policy

(From Official FAST National University Fee Structure Page — nu.edu.pk/Admissions/FeeStructure, revised guidelines effective December 20, 2024)

The Admission Fee is non-refundable under all circumstances. The Security Deposit is refundable at the time of completion of the degree or at the closing of the admission. Tuition fee is refunded in accordance with the revised Higher Education Commission guidelines, effective from December 20, 2024.

Up to the 10th day of commencement of classes: 100% fee refund.

Up to the 15th day of commencement of classes: 80% fee refund.

Up to the 20th day of commencement of classes: 60% fee refund.

Up to the 30th day of commencement of classes: 50% fee refund.

From the 31st day onwards of commencement of classes: No refund.

Days for the purpose of refund calculation are counted including both working days and holidays. If a student's admission is cancelled after declaration of results due to failure to meet eligibility requirements, the fee refund is calculated from the date of their result announcement.

Scholarships and Financial Assistance

(From Official FAST National University Scholarships Page —
nu.edu.pk/Admissions/Scholarship)

Merit Scholarships for Bachelor Students: A merit scholarship is awarded to the top three position holders of each Examination Board in the year of admission. Scholarship is also offered to the top three position holders in the FAST National University admission merit list. This scholarship covers the full tuition fee for four years of uninterrupted studies with a full course load. Continuation of the merit scholarship requires maintaining a semester Grade Point Average of 3.0 or higher.

Higher Education Commission Scholarships for Master of Science and PhD Students: The Higher Education Commission provides liberal scholarships to students enrolled in Master of Science and PhD programs at this university. The scholarship covers tuition fee, a monthly stipend, and a book allowance.

Punjab Educational Endowment Fund Scholarships: The Government of Punjab offers 42 scholarships to financially needy students holding a Punjab domicile. Newly admitted students at any campus of the university can apply. The scholarship covers four years of undergraduate studies and covers a portion of the tuition fee. The remaining tuition fee may be provided by the university as an interest-free loan.

Sindh Government Endowment Board Scholarships: The Sindh Government offers scholarships to students at the Karachi campus on a need-cum-merit basis for both undergraduate and graduate studies. The scholarship covers full tuition fee for the entire duration of the program and is renewable every year. The quota allocates 60% of seats to students from rural Sindh and the remaining 40% to students from urban areas. Approximately 25 new scholarships are offered every year under this scheme.

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Education Foundation Scholarship: The Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Government offers scholarships to students at the Peshawar campus on a need-cum-merit basis for Bachelor of Science and Master of Science programs, with equal male to female ratio. The scholarship covers 80% of the tuition fee for the entire duration of the program.

Baluchistan Government Endowment Board Scholarship: The Baluchistan Government offers scholarships to students at the Karachi campus on a need-cum-merit basis for both undergraduate and graduate studies. The scholarship covers full tuition fee for the entire duration of the program, renewable every year.

Old Students Association of FAST Financial Assistance — Study Loan: The Old Students Association of FAST arranges financial assistance for students who cannot afford to pay their full fee.

Interest-Free Study Loan: FAST National University provides interest-free, need-based study loans for bright and financially deserving students. This assistance is limited to tuition fee only and is subject to renewal every semester based on academic performance. The loan is discontinued if the student's Cumulative Grade Point Average falls below the minimum specified to avoid academic warning. Loan recipients must take a full course load each semester. Repayment begins three months after graduation or upon employment, whichever is earlier, and the total amount must be repaid within four years of graduation. Students sign a contract allowing future employers to deduct loan repayments at source.

Other Community Scholarships: Additional scholarships are available from Memon Community, Bohra Community, INFAQ Foundation, Agha Khan Foundation, and other

community-based organizations. For the Karachi campus specifically, the Alumni Association, the Hindu Community, and the Agha Khan Foundation also provide scholarships in limited numbers.

Bank Loans: Several banks including PICIC Commercial Bank, NIB Bank, Bank Alfalah, Bank Islami, and MCB offer student loans to enrolled students.

Chief Minister's Honhaar Undergraduate Scholarship Program is also available for eligible students at the Karachi campus, as announced in October 2024.

Campus Facilities

(From Official FAST Karachi Campus Website — khi.nu.edu.pk and Official FAST National University Student Services — nu.edu.pk)

Library: The FAST National University Library is accessible online through the university's digital library portal. The library supports academic research and is integrated across all campuses.

Student Societies and Extracurricular Activities: The Karachi campus hosts a range of student societies supporting technical, cultural, and extracurricular engagement. Students are encouraged to participate in and organize events, competitions, and community initiatives.

Medical Room: A medical room is available at the Karachi campus for student health and wellness needs. The Department of Medical, Wellness, and Sports also organizes training programs such as First Aid practices in collaboration with the Quality Enhancement Cell.

Student Chapters: The university hosts an Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers student chapter.